

About the Operational Entropy Index

A current overview of the OEI framework, diagnostic method, and engagement ecosystem

What the OEI is

The Operational Entropy Index (OEI) is a proprietary diagnostic tool and structured intervention process built to identify, measure, and reduce the organizational drag that erodes execution speed as companies scale.

Operational entropy is the tendency for disorder, friction, and unnecessary complexity to accumulate over time. It appears when decisions require more coordination, knowledge becomes fragmented, workflows slow down, tools create workarounds, or responsibilities fail during handoffs.

Entropy cannot be permanently eliminated. The objective is to identify and mitigate it, measure whether interventions work, and establish mechanisms that help prevent it from rapidly returning.

OEI is a structured, repeatable diagnostic process. It combines evidence from people, workflows, systems, and operating outcomes rather than relying on a single opinion or generic consulting template.

The five diagnostic categories

1. Founder Dependency

Is the company operationally hostage to one person's presence? Measures reliance on founders or other key individuals for approvals, decisions, context, and operational continuity.

2. Knowledge Logistics

Does the right information reach the right people reliably? Examines how critical context is documented, updated, retrieved, transferred, and used.

3. Workflow Velocity

Where is execution speed being lost in the process chain? Traces waiting, approval latency, rework, unclear ownership, and other causes of lost momentum.

4. Tool Discipline

Are systems fit for purpose and used consistently? Evaluates tool fit, adoption, training, process alignment, redundant applications, and manual workarounds.

5. Handoff Integrity

Do responsibility and context transfer cleanly between people or teams? Examines ownership transitions, readiness criteria, shared context, and accountability across handoffs.

How the OEI works

- **Structured interviews:** Gather evidence from people across the company, not only leadership.
- **Workflow mapping:** Trace how work actually moves and where approvals, dependencies, or handoffs fail.
- **Operational testing:** Measure cycle time, consistency, rework, adoption, and other observable outcomes.
- **Root-cause mapping:** Connect visible symptoms to the structural conditions producing them.

What an engagement produces

- A baseline OEI score across the five dimensions.
- A map of where execution is leaking and the root causes involved.
- A prioritized roadmap of structural changes.
- Proof-of-concept improvements appropriate to the engagement scope.

Ways to work with OEI

The consulting pathway includes an Initial OEI Diagnosis, 15- or 30-Day Audits, a 30-Day Single Pain Point Sprint, a 90-Day Operational Entropy Reset, and One-Year OEI Trend Analysis. Most comprehensive work starts with the diagnosis, while focused investigations provide a faster route when the problem is already visible.

Focused Operational Investigations

Founder Absence Simulation, Institutional Memory Recovery Sprint, Workflow Momentum Analysis, Operational Stack Review, and Handoff Failure Analysis are bounded investigations typically priced from \$1,000 to \$4,000 USD.

Entropy Compatible Hiring

Entropy Compatible Hiring (ECH) is separate Windows desktop software. It provides ten role-agnostic, OEI-derived interview instruments that help organizations observe operational behavior through applied exercises, predefined signals, and evidence capture.

ECH is not a personality test, does not score overall candidate quality, and does not replace evaluation of skills, experience, technical competence, references, or broader hiring fit. A formal OEI engagement is not required. Version 0.1.0 BETA is offered as a one-time purchase for \$950-\$1,450 USD.